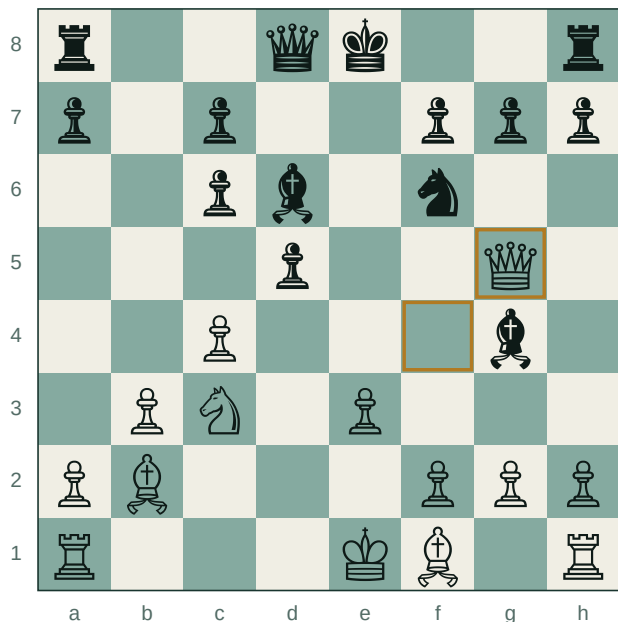


Clearance tactics: Black, move 12

Clearance tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 12.Qg5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

12...h6 13. Qxg7 Rh7 14. Qxh7 Nxh7

12...h6 The pawn moves from h7 to h6. Recorded reply: **13.Qxg7**.

13...Rh7 The rook moves from h8 to h7. Recorded reply: **14.Qxh7**.

14...Nxh7 The knight captures the queen on h7.

At the end, nominal material is White 26 / Black 29 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on e1. Geometrically undefended: queen on g5 and bishop on b2. Check for tactical protection.